

North Atlantic Recreational Fishing Survey 2025



Improve your fishing experiences!



Sponsored by NOAA Fisheries (National Marine Fisheries Service), Northeast Fisheries Science Center

This survey is voluntary and all responses are confidential.
Questions? Call 800-XXX-XXXX or email Scott Steinback at
Scott.Steinback@noaa.gov

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SECTION A: YOUR RECREATIONAL SALTWATER FISHING EXPERIENCES

These questions are about you and your recreational saltwater fishing experiences.

Please do not include any information about other people you go fishing with.

1. **Within the last five years**, which of the following species have you gone fishing for, even if you didn't catch or keep any? Please select all that apply.



Haddock

☐

Pollock

☐

Cod

☐

☐ None of these species → Go to Section C on Page 10

2. **During 2024**, which of the following species did you go fishing for, even if you didn't catch or keep any? Please select all that apply.



Haddock

☐

Pollock

☐

Cod

☐

3. **During 2024**, on how many trips did you go fishing for **cod, haddock, or pollock** even if you didn't catch or keep any? Please fill in the number of trips by fishing mode.

Party or head boat (usually 25 or more anglers per boat)..... # 2024 trips

Charter or guide boat (usually 1-6 anglers per boat)..... # 2024 trips

From shore..... # 2024 trips

Private boat (owned or rented by you, a friend, or a relative)..... # 2024 trips

4. Do you own, or have regular access to a boat used for recreational fishing?

☐ Yes

☐ No

5. How likely or unlikely are you to go recreational fishing for **cod, haddock, or pollock** in the next twelve months?

☐ Very Likely

☐ Somewhat likely

☐ Somewhat unlikely

☐ Very unlikely

SECTION B: YOUR SALTWATER FISHING TRIP PREFERENCES

Your answers to the next six questions are extremely important to the success of the survey because they will be directly incorporated into the policy making process. Please make your voice heard by answering each of these questions.

Each question will present you with three alternative trips like in the example below. Trips A and B are hypothetical fishing trips with different catch levels and trip costs. Trip C is doing something other than saltwater fishing.

After comparing the three TRIPS, indicate which one would be your first choice.

Please do the following things to make sure we represent your thinking accurately.

1. Answer each question as if you were presented with the three options in the real world.
2. If you would not pay the amount listed for either fishing trip option, choose Trip C.
3. There are no right or wrong answers, we simply want to understand the tradeoffs that anglers like you are willing to make.

EXAMPLE

Regulations	
You are legally allowed to keep: X Cod, 24" or longer X Haddock, 17" or longer	

Trip Features	Trip A	Trip B	Trip C
TOTAL NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.	X Cod	X Cod	Do something other than saltwater fishing
NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size fish</u> .	X Cod	X Cod	
TOTAL NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch.	X Haddock	X Haddock	
NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can be legally kept</u> .	X Haddock	X Haddock	
TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip	\$X	\$X	

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? → (Choose only one option.)	Trip A ☐	Trip B ☐	Trip C ☐
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SECTION B: SALTWATER FISHING TRIPS

Suppose that you have the choice between two recreational saltwater fishing trips (**Trip A** or **Trip B**) and not going recreational saltwater fishing (**Trip C**). Below the table, indicate which of these three options would be your first choice.

REGULATIONS
You are legally allowed to keep: 3 Cod, 24" or longer 12 Haddock, 17" or longer

TRIP FEATURES		Trip A	Trip B	Trip C
CATCH	TOTAL NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.	6 Cod	4 Cod	Do something other than saltwater fishing.
	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> .	3 Cod	1 Cod	
	TOTAL NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch.	10 Haddock	7 Haddock	
	NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can</u> be <u>legally kept</u> .	8 Haddock	3 Haddock	
TRIP DETAILS	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.	\$160	\$75	

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →

(Choose only one option.)

Trip A
☐

Trip B
☐

Trip C
☐

SECTION B: SALTWATER FISHING TRIPS

Suppose that you have the choice between two recreational saltwater fishing trips (**Trip A** or **Trip B**) and not going recreational saltwater fishing (**Trip C**). Below the table, indicate which of these three options would be your first choice.

REGULATIONS
You are legally allowed to keep: 2 Cod, 24" or longer 9 Haddock, 17" or longer

TRIP FEATURES		Trip A		Trip B		Trip C	
CATCH	TOTAL NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.		3 Cod		5 Cod		Do something other than saltwater fishing.
	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> .		2 Cod		0 Cod		
	TOTAL NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch.		7 Haddock		9 Haddock		
	NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can</u> be <u>legally kept</u> .		5 Haddock		4 Haddock		
TRIP DETAILS	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.		\$160		\$45		

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →

(Choose only one option.)

Trip A
☐

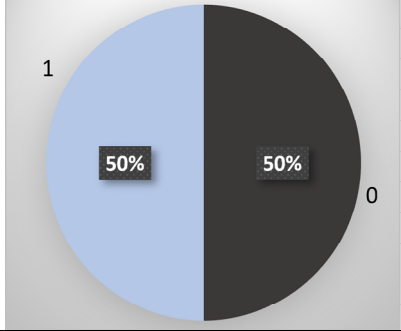
Trip B
☐

Trip C
☐

SECTION B: SALTWATER FISHING TRIPS

Suppose that you have the choice between two recreational saltwater fishing trips (**Trip A** or **Trip B**) and not going recreational saltwater fishing (**Trip C**). Below the table, indicate which of these three options would be your first choice.

REGULATIONS
You are legally allowed to keep: 1 Cod, 24" or longer 20 Haddock 17" or longer

TRIP FEATURES		Trip A	Trip B	Trip C
CATCH	TOTAL NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.	1 Cod	1 Cod	Do something other than saltwater fishing.
	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> .	1 Cod	50% chance of 0 Cod 50% chance of 1 Cod No chance of more than 1 Cod 	
	TOTAL NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch. NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can be legally kept</u> .	20 Haddock 15 Haddock	15 Haddock 10 Haddock	
TRIP DETAILS	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.	\$340	\$160	

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →
(Choose only one option.)

Trip A



Trip B



Trip C

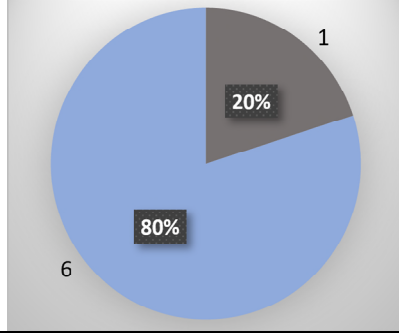


SECTION B: SALTWATER FISHING TRIPS

Suppose that you have the choice between two recreational saltwater fishing trips (**Trip A** or **Trip B**) and not going recreational saltwater fishing (**Trip C**). Below the table, indicate which of these three options would be your first choice.

REGULATIONS

You are legally allowed to keep:
6 Cod, 24" or longer
18 Haddock, 17" or longer

TRIP FEATURES		Trip A	Trip B	Trip C
CATCH	TOTAL NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.	1 Cod	8 Cod	Do something other than saltwater fishing.
	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> .	1 Cod	20% chance of 1 Cod 80% chance of 6 Cod No chance of more than 6 Cod 	
	TOTAL NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch. NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can</u> be <u>legally kept</u> .	10 Haddock 3 Haddock	0 Haddock 0 Haddock	
TRIP DETAILS	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.	\$30	\$420	

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →
(Choose only one option.)

Trip A

☐

Trip B

☐

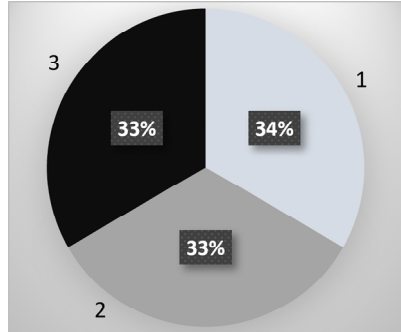
Trip C

☐

SECTION B: SALTWATER FISHING TRIPS

Suppose that you have the choice between two recreational saltwater fishing trips (**Trip A** or **Trip B**) and not going recreational saltwater fishing (**Trip C**). Below the table, indicate which of these three options would be your first choice.

REGULATIONS
You are legally allowed to keep: 3 Cod, 24" or longer 22 Haddock, 17" or longer

TRIP FEATURES		Trip A	Trip B	Trip C
CATCH	TOTAL NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.	3 Cod	4 Cod	Do something other than saltwater fishing.
	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> .	0 to 3 Cod	34% chance of 1 Cod 33% chance of 2 Cod 33% chance of 3 Cod No chance of more than 3 Cod 	
	TOTAL NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch. NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can be legally kept</u> .	25 Haddock 10 Haddock	10 Haddock 5 Haddock	
TRIP DETAILS	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.	\$160	\$340	

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →
(Choose only one option.)

Trip A



Trip B



Trip C



SECTION B: SALTWATER FISHING TRIPS

Suppose that you have the choice between two recreational saltwater fishing trips (**Trip A** or **Trip B**) and not going recreational saltwater fishing (**Trip C**). Below the table, indicate which of these three options would be your first choice.

REGULATIONS
You are legally allowed to keep: 2 Cod, 24" or longer 20 Haddock, 17" or longer

TRIP FEATURES		Trip A		Trip B		Trip C	
CATCH	TOTAL NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.		0 to 5 Cod		3 Cod		Do something other than saltwater fishing.
	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> .		0 to 2 Cod		1 Cod		
	TOTAL NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch.		13 Haddock		20 Haddock		
	NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can be legally kept</u> .		10 Haddock		7 Haddock		
TRIP DETAILS	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.		\$130		\$60		

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →
(Choose only one option.)

Trip A

☐

Trip B

☐

Trip C

☐

SECTION C: ABOUT YOU AND YOUR HOUSEHOLD

These questions will help us understand whether our sample is representative of the angler population.

6. Are you male or female?

☐

Male

☐

Female

7. In what year were you born?

Year born (YYYY)

8. What is the highest level of education you have completed?

☐

Some high school

☐

4-year degree

☐

High school graduate or GED

☐

Some graduate school

☐

2-year degree or trade school graduate

☐

Master's degree (ex: MA, MS, MBA)

☐

Some college

☐

Professional or doctoral degree

9. Which of the following categories best describes your household's total annual income before taxes in 2021?

☐

Less than \$20,000

☐

\$80,000 to \$99,999

☐

\$20,000 to \$39,999

☐

\$100,000 to \$149,999

☐

\$40,000 to \$59,999

☐

\$150,000 to \$199,999

☐

\$60,000 to \$79,999

☐

\$200,000 or more

THANK YOU FOR PARTICIPATING!

If you have any questions regarding the survey, please call 800-XXX-XXXX
or email Scott.Steinback@noaa.gov